

Self-denial



Christ set an example of.

Matthew 4:8-10 Again, the devil taketh him up into an exceeding high mountain, and sheweth him all the kingdoms of the world, and the glory of them; 9 And saith unto him, All these things will I give thee, if thou wilt fall down and worship me. 10 Then saith Jesus unto him, Get thee hence, Satan: for it is written, Thou shalt worship the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve.

Matthew 8:20 And Jesus saith unto him, The foxes have holes, and the birds of the air have nests; but The Son Of Man hath not where to lay his head.

John 6:38 For I came down from heaven, not to do mine own will, but the will of him that sent me.

Romans 15:3 For even Christ pleased not himself; but, as it is written, The reproaches of them that reproached thee fell on me.

Philippians 2:6-8 Who, being in the form of God, thought it not robbery to be equal with God: 7 But made himself of no reputation, and took upon him the form of a Servant, and was made in the likeness of men: 8 And being found in fashion as a man, he humbled himself, and became obedient unto Death, even the Death of the cross.

A test of devotedness to Christ.

Matthew 10:37-38 He that loveth Father or mother more than me is not worthy of me: and he that loveth son or daughter more than me is not worthy of me. 38 And he that taketh not his cross, and followeth after me, is not worthy of me.

NECESSARY

In following Christ.

Luke 14:27-33 And whosoever doth not bear his cross, and come after me, cannot be my disciple. 28 For which of you, intending to build a tower, sitteth not down first, and counteth the cost, whether he have sufficient to finish it? 29 Lest haply, after he hath laid the foundation, and is not able to finish it, all that behold it begin to mock him, 30 Saying, This man began to build, and was not able to finish. ...

In the warfare of Saints.

2 Timothy 2:4 No man that warreth entangleth himself with the affairs of this life; that he may please him who hath Chosen him to be a soldier.

To the triumph of Saints.

1 Corinthians 9:25-27 And every man that striveth for the mastery is temperate in all things. Now they do it to obtain a corruptible crown; but we an incorruptible. 26 I therefore so run, not as uncertainly; so fight I, not as one that beateth the air: 27 But I keep under my body, and bring it into subjection: lest that by any means, when I have preached to others, I myself should be a castaway.

Ministers especially called to exercise.

2 Corinthians 6:4-5 But in all things approving ourselves as the ministers of God, in much Patience, in Afflictions, in necessities, in distresses, 5 In stripes, in imprisonments, in tumults, in labours, in watchings, in fastings;

SHOULD BE EXERCISED IN

Denying ungodliness and worldly lusts.

Romans 6:12 Let not Sin therefore reign in your mortal body, that ye should obey it in the lusts thereof.

Titus 2:12 Teaching us that, denying ungodliness and worldly lusts, we should live soberly, righteously, and godly, in this present world;

Controlling the appetite.

Proverbs 23:2 And put a knife to thy throat, if thou be a man given to appetite.

Abstaining from fleshly lusts.

1 Peter 2:11 Dearly beloved, I Beseech you as strangers and pilgrims, abstain from fleshly lusts, which war against the soul;

No longer living to lusts of men.

1 Peter 4:2 That he no longer should live the rest of his time in the flesh to the lusts of men, but to the will of God.

Mortifying sinful lusts.

Mark 9:43 And if thy hand offend thee, cut it off: it is better for thee to enter into life maimed, than having two hands to go into Hell, into the fire that never shall be quenched:

Colossians 3:5 Mortify therefore your members which are upon the earth; Fornication, uncleanness, inordinate affection, evil Concupiscence, and covetousness, which is idolatry:

Mortifying deeds of the body.

Romans 8:13 For if ye live after the flesh, ye shall die: but if ye through the Spirit do mortify the deeds of the body, ye shall live.

Not pleasing ourselves.

Romans 15:1-3 We then that are strong ought to bear the infirmities of the weak, and not to please ourselves. 2 Let every one of us please his neighbour for his good to edification. 3 For even Christ pleased not himself; but, as it is written, The reproaches of them that reproached thee fell on me.

Not seeking our own profit.

1 Corinthians 10:24 Let no man seek his own, but every man another's wealth.

1 Corinthians 13:5 Doth not behave itself unseemly, seeketh not her own, is not easily provoked, thinketh no evil;

Philippians 2:4 Look not every man on his own things, but every man also on the things of others.

Preferring the profit of others.

Romans 14:20-21 For meat destroy not the work of God. All things indeed are pure; but it is evil for that man who eateth with offence. 21 It is good neither to eat flesh, nor to drink wine, nor any thing whereby thy brother stumbleth, or is offended, or is made weak.

1 Corinthians 10:24 Let no man seek his own, but every man another's wealth.

1 Corinthians 10:33 Even as I please all men in all things, not seeking mine own profit, but the profit of many, that they may be saved.

Assisting others.

Luke 3:11 He answereth and saith unto them, He that hath two Coats, let him impart to him that hath none; and he that hath meat, let him do likewise.

Even lawful things.

1 Corinthians 10:23 All things are lawful for me, but all things are not expedient: all things are lawful for me, but all things edify not.

Forsaking all.

Luke 14:33 So likewise, whosoever he be of you that forsaketh not all that he hath, he cannot be my disciple.

Taking up the cross and following Christ.

Matthew 10:38 And he that taketh not his cross, and followeth after me, is not worthy of me.

Matthew 16:24 Then said Jesus unto his disciples, If any man will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow me.

Crucifying the flesh.

Galatians 5:24 And they that are Christ's have crucified the flesh with the Affections and lusts.

Being crucified with Christ.

Romans 6:6 Knowing this, that our old man is crucified with him, that the body of Sin might be destroyed, that henceforth we should not serve Sin.

Being crucified unto the world.

Galatians 6:14 But God forbid that I should glory, save in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, by whom the world is crucified unto me, and I unto the world.

Putting off the old man which is corrupt.

Ephesians 4:22 That ye put off concerning the former Conversation the old man, which is corrupt according to the deceitful lusts;

Colossians 3:9 Lie not one to another, seeing that ye have put off the old man with his deeds;

Preferring Christ to all earthly relations.

Matthew 8:21-22 And another of his disciples said unto him, Lord, suffer me first to go and bury my Father. 22 But Jesus said unto him, Follow me; and let the Dead bury their Dead.

Becomes strangers and pilgrims.

Hebrews 11:13-15 These all died in Faith, not having received the promises, but having seen them afar off, and were persuaded of them, and embraced them, and confessed that they were strangers and pilgrims on the earth. 14 For they that say such things declare plainly that they seek a country. 15 And truly, if they had been mindful of that country from whence they came out, they might have had opportunity to have returned.

1 Peter 2:11 Dearly beloved, I Beseech you as strangers and pilgrims, abstain from fleshly lusts, which war against the soul;

danger of neglecting.

Matthew 16:25-26 For whosoever will save his life shall lose it: and whosoever will lose his life for my sake shall find it. 26 For what is a man profited, if he shall gain the whole world, and lose his own soul? or what shall a man give in exchange for his soul?

1 Corinthians 9:27 But I keep under my body, and bring it into subjection: lest that by any means, when I have preached to others, I myself should be a castaway.

Reward of.

Matthew 19:28-29 And Jesus said unto them, Verily I say unto you, That ye which have followed me, in the regeneration when The Son Of Man shall sit in the throne of his glory, ye also shall sit upon twelve thrones, judging the twelve Tribes of Israel. 29 And every one that hath forsaken houses, or Brethren, or sisters, or Father, or mother, or wife, or children, or lands, for my name's sake, shall receive an hundredfold, and shall inherit everlasting life.

Happy result.

2 Peter 1:4 Whereby are given unto us exceeding great and precious promises: that by these ye might be partakers of the divine nature, having escaped the corruption that is in the world through lust.

Exemplified.

Abraham,

Genesis 13:9 Is not the whole land before thee? separate thyself, I pray thee, from me: if thou wilt take the left hand, then I will go to the right; or if thou depart to the right hand, then I will go to the left.

Hebrews 11:8-9 By Faith Abraham, when he was called to go out into a place which he should after receive for an inheritance, obeyed; and he went out, not knowing whither he went. 9 By Faith he sojourned in the land of promise, as in a strange country, dwelling in tabernacles with Isaac and Jacob, the heirs with him of the same promise:

Widow of Zarephath,

1 Kings 17:12-15 And she said, As the LORD thy God liveth, I have not a cake, but an handful of meal in a barrel, and a little oil in a Cruse: and, behold, I am gathering two sticks, that I may go in and dress it for me and my son, that we may eat it, and die. 13 And Elijah said unto her, Fear not; go and do as thou hast said: but make me thereof a little cake first, and bring it unto me, and after make for thee and for thy son. 14 For thus saith the LORD God of Israel, The barrel of meal shall not waste, neither shall the Cruse of oil fail, until the day that the LORD sendeth Rain upon the earth. 15 And she went and did according to the saying of Elijah: and she, and he, and her house, did eat many days.

Esther,

Esther 4:16 Go, gather together all the Jews that are present in Shushan, and fast ye for me, and neither eat nor drink three days, night or day: I also and my maidens will fast likewise; and so will I go in unto the king, which is not according to The Law: and if I perish, I perish.

Rechabites,

Jeremiah 35:6-7 But they said, We will drink no wine: for Jonadab the son of Rechab our Father commanded us, saying, Ye shall drink no wine, neither ye, nor your sons for ever: 7 Neither shall ye build house, nor sow seed, nor plant vineyard, nor have any: but all your days ye shall dwell in tents; that ye may live many days in the land where ye be strangers.

Daniel,

Daniel 1:8-16 But Daniel purposed in his heart that he would not defile himself with the portion of the king's meat, nor with the wine which he drank: therefore he requested of the prince of the eunuchs that he might not defile himself. 9 Now God had brought Daniel into favour and tender love with the prince of the eunuchs. 10 And the prince of the eunuchs said unto Daniel, I fear my lord the king, who hath appointed your meat and your drink: for why should he see your faces worse liking than the children which are of your sort? then shall ye make me endanger my head to the king. 11 Then said

Daniel to Melzar, whom the prince of the eunuchs had set over Daniel, Hananiah, Mishaël, and Azariah, ...

Apostles,

Matthew 19:27 Then answered Peter and said unto him, Behold, we have forsaken all, and followed thee; what shall we have therefore?

Simon, Andrew, James, and John,

Mark 1:16-20 Now as he walked by the sea of Galilee, he saw Simon and Andrew his brother casting a net into the sea: for they were fishers. 17 And Jesus said unto them, Come ye after me, and I will make you to become fishers of men. 18 And straightway they forsook their nets, and followed him. 19 And when he had gone a little further thence, he saw James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother, who also were in the ship mending their nets. ...

Poor Widow,

Luke 21:4 For all these have of their Abundance cast in unto the offerings of God: but she of her penury hath cast in all the living that she had.

Primitive Christians,

Acts 2:45 And sold their possessions and goods, and parted them to all men, as every man had need.

Acts 4:34 Neither was there any among them that lacked: for as many as were possessors of lands or houses sold them, and brought the prices of the things that were sold,

Barnabas,

Acts 4:36-37 And Joses, who by the Apostles was surnamed Barnabas, (which is, being interpreted, The son of consolation,) a Levite, and of the country of Cyprus, 37 Having land, sold it, and brought the money, and laid it at the Apostles' feet.

Paul,

Acts 20:24 But none of these things move me, neither count I my life dear unto myself, so that I might finish my course with joy, and the ministry, which I have received of the Lord Jesus, to testify the Gospel of the grace of God.

1 Corinthians 9:19 For though I be free from all men, yet have I made myself Servant unto all, that I might gain the more.

1 Corinthians 9:27 But I keep under my body, and bring it into subjection: lest that by any means, when I have preached to others, I myself should be a castaway.

Moses,

Hebrews 11:24-25 By Faith Moses, when he was come to years, refused to be called the son of Pharaoh's daughter; 25 Choosing rather to suffer Affliction with the people of God, than to enjoy the pleasures of Sin for a season;